

Joe Karlsson

Head of Developer Relations

joekarlsson.com

joekarlsson1@gmail.com

linkedin.com/in/joekarlsson

github.com/JoeKarlsson

bsky: @joekarlsson.com

I've spent 15 years making complex data systems click for developers - through talks, docs, demos, content, and building things that probably shouldn't exist. I run full DevRel functions at data companies, with a track record in organic growth, developer activation, and pipeline influence.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Developer Relations

2024 - Present

CloudQuery · Remote

GCP · AWS · Azure · ClickHouse · Python · SQL

- Embedded cross-functionally across Sales, Product, and Engineering - partner with Sales on enablement assets, serve as product owner of all marketing channels, and attend daily engineering standups; 373+ PRs merged directly into company apps and growing daily
- Sole owner of all CloudQuery web properties including the marketing site, docs, and developer hub; responsible for the full developer experience from first Google result to trial activation
- Built AI automations for sales enablement asset production (one-pagers, discovery decks, pitch slides) - enabling the team to scale output without adding headcount
- Built interactive demos and reference architectures used in conference talks, customer demos, and blog content - including an end-to-end secure AI data pipelines architecture
- Built and own the entire DevRel function from scratch: content strategy, community, event strategy, and full video and social production
- Produce content across every format: 80+ blog posts and learning center articles, YouTube tutorials, product demo videos, webinar series, and social content across LinkedIn, X, and developer communities; speak at conferences and staff booth during event season
- Organic MQLs +216% MoM; demo submissions 7x MoM; non-branded organic traffic up 44% over 3 months
- Search impressions 4.9x to a new all-time high; average position improved from 21 to 10
- Docs traffic +302%; Quickstart completions from zero to meaningful weekly volume after full docs rewrite

Senior Developer Advocate

2023 - 2024

Tinybird · Remote

SQL · ClickHouse · BigQuery · Kafka · Snowflake · Redshift · Python · GCP · AWS

- Partnered closely with the Sales team on pre-sales support and customer demos - integrated with prospects' existing tech stacks to build tailored demos that showed exactly how Tinybird fit their architecture
- Built real-time technical integrations for demos and customer proof-of-concepts: fraud detection system on GCP/BigQuery/Kafka (33% reduction in fraudulent transactions); BigQuery IoT optimization for a trucking firm (40% compute cost reduction, 30% faster data retrieval)
- Produced technical content, videos, and webinars covering real-time analytics use cases for a developer audience
- Built community through workshops, online forums, and conference representation

Senior Developer Advocate

2021 - 2023

SingleStore · Remote

SQL · MySQL · Go · Node.js

- Led content and video production strategy for SingleStore's developer audience - technical tutorials, conference talks, and demos targeting developers migrating from MySQL and PostgreSQL
- Built co-marketing partnerships with cloud providers and tooling partners, coordinating joint content, webinars, and conference activations with their marketing and DevRel teams
- Planned and executed developer conference presence end-to-end: talk submissions, booth strategy, event logistics, and post-event content amplification
- Worked cross-functionally with Engineering, Documentation, and Sales to align content with product launches, maintain technical accuracy, and support pre-sales needs

Developer Advocate

2019 - 2021

MongoDB · Remote

JavaScript · Node.js · Python · React · MongoDB · AWS

- Keynoted at MongoDB World and led global conference event strategy; when COVID hit, pivoted to lead MongoDB's digital growth strategy across Twitch, YouTube, and social - driving developer awareness and product adoption through an entirely new channel mix
- Built memorable technical demos to showcase MongoDB features in creative, engaging ways: IoT kitty litter box, IoT digital graffiti board, and dozens of other projects that drove community growth and product awareness
- Owned MongoDB's live stream and video production, building a 25K+ TikTok following; ranked #1 on "Must-Follow Developers on TikTok"
- Played a key role in defining and standardizing MongoDB developer best practices - authored canonical guides and videos on schema design, aggregation, and Atlas that became the reference point for the ecosystem; published across MongoDB Developer Hub, The New Stack, and Medium

Front End Technical Lead

2017 - 2019

Best Buy · Minneapolis, MN

JavaScript · Node.js · React · Redux · Express · AWS

- Led a cross-functional team of 10 engineers, QA, and product on one of the top 3 largest eCommerce sites in North America - a platform handling millions of users and thousands of requests per second
- Owned Account Home for bestbuy.com end-to-end: drove full redesign and implementation partnering closely with UX, product, and backend teams
- Engineered AI-driven chatbot using NLP and ML that reduced customer support call volume by 25%

Full-Stack JavaScript Instructor

2015 - 2017

DevLeague · Honolulu, HI

ES6 · JavaScript · Node.js · React · Angular · PostgreSQL · AWS

- Taught full-stack JavaScript at one of the top 10 coding bootcamps worldwide
- Developed curriculum, led workshops, and mentored students into engineering roles at local and national companies

SKILLS

LANGUAGES

JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, Go, Rust, SQL

AI & AUTOMATION

LLM APIs, AI Workflow Automation, Prompt Engineering, AI-assisted Content Pipelines, Sales Enablement Automation

DATABASES

MongoDB, PostgreSQL, MySQL, ClickHouse, Redis, Elasticsearch, SingleStore

FRONTEND

React, Redux, Astro, Tailwind CSS, D3.js

CLOUD & DATA

AWS, GCP, Azure, BigQuery, Snowflake, Kafka, Airflow

DEVREL & MARKETING

Technical Writing, Conference Speaking, Content Strategy, SEO, Conversion Optimization, Sales Enablement, Marketing Analytics, Community, Webinars

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts in Computer Science

2008 - 2012

Gustavus Adolphus College

GPA: 3.5 · Minors: Art History, Math